

Research Assistant

Computational Neuroscience and Psychiatry

Department of Psychology

School of Health and Psychological Sciences

www.city.ac.uk/

January 2024



Role Profile	
Post:	Research Assistant
Department:	Psychology
School:	Health and Psychological Sciences
Grade:	5B
Tenure:	Permanent and fixed term for 6 months
Responsible to:	Dimitrios Pinotsis

Context

City, University of London is a global university committed to academic excellence with a focus on business and the professions and an enviable central London location.

City attracts around 20,000 students (40% postgraduate level) from more than 150 countries and staff from over 75 countries.

In the last decade City has almost tripled the proportion of its total academic staff producing world-leading or internationally excellent research. During this period City has made significant investments in its academic staff, its estate and its infrastructure and continues to work towards realising its vision of being a leading global university.

The Department

The Department of Psychology is committed to maintaining a high standard of research excellence. The Department of Psychology at City, University of London was included in the top 150 of 2024 Time Higher Education World Rankings. It is consistently ranked among the top Psychology departments in the UK.

To this end, applicants will be expected to demonstrate a flair for inspiring students in their research activity, as well as demonstrating academic excellence.

The Computational Neuroscience and Psychiatry Lab

The Computational Neuroscience and Psychiatry Lab (www.pinotsislab.com) at City— University of London focuses on developing new algorithms for the analysis of human and animal brain imaging data. These are based on computational models of neural dynamics and state of the art machine learning techniques. Particular emphasis is put on applications in Computational Psychiatry and developing models of brain pathology. Also, the Lab develops brain theories that can explain brain pathology, using theoretical tools from deep neural networks and Bayesian brain theories. The lab also performs EEG recordings and plans to start experiments with EEG neurofeedback.

Job Purpose

To make a significant contribution to the achievement of the academic objectives of the School and to academic excellence at City, University of London, in line with the University's Strategic Plan and supporting strategies. To make a wider contribution as a member/leader of the academic community, appropriate to the role level.

Main Responsibilities

- Analysing human data in collaboration with other researchers and partners locally and internationally.
- Collecting data recorded during cognitive neuroscience studies
- Contributing to manuscripts presenting findings that will be submitted in peer-reviewed journals/scientific conferences.

Additional information

- The post holder must at all times carry out their responsibilities with due regard to City, University of London's Equal Opportunities Statement.
- The post holder must accept responsibility for ensuring that the policies and procedures relating to Health and Safety in the workplace are adhered to at all times.
- The post holder must respect the confidentiality of data stored electronically and by other means in line with General Data Protection Regulation 2018 (GDPR) the Data Protection Act 2018.
- The post holder must carry out their responsibilities with due regard to the non-smoking environment of City, University of London.
- Workplace values

The post holder will be expected to operate in line with City's workplace values which are:

- We care
- We learn
- We act

Sustainable Development

City, University of London is committed to a policy of best practice to assist in building a sustainable way of life by taking a positive, solutions-orientated approach. All post holders are encouraged to contribute through their roles to improving the environment for City and the wider community.

Details of policy, information and staff development supporting the policy on the environment and sustainability can be found at www.city.ac.uk/green-policies.

The above list is not exclusive or exhaustive and the post holder will be required to undertake such duties as may reasonably be expected within the scope and grading of the post. All members of staff are required to be professional, co-operative and flexible in line with the needs of the post, Department, School and City, University of London.

Job descriptions should be regularly reviewed and at least prior to the annual appraisal, if applicable or on a regular basis to ensure they are an accurate representation of the post.

Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Statement (EDI)

City, University of London is committed to promoting equality, diversity and inclusion in all its activities, processes, and culture for our whole community, including staff, students and visitors.

We welcome applications regardless of age, caring responsibilities, disability, gender identity, gender reassignment, marital status, nationality, pregnancy, race and ethnic origin, religion and belief, sex, sexual orientation and socio-economic background.

City operates a guaranteed interview scheme for disabled applicants.

Person Specification	
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Criteria	Essential (E) or Desirable (D)	Method(s) of Assessment: Application (A), Interview (I) or Exercise (E)
Qualifications and Knowledge		
An MSc in computer science, mathematics, neuroscience or similar field.	E	A
Expertise in one or more modern scientific computing programming language (Python, Matlab or R) is essential.	E	I
Understanding of the analysis of human, animal brain imaging data.	D	I
Experience		
- EEG data collection - Data Analysis - Research Methods	D E E	I A A
Skills and Abilities		
- Ability to meet strict timetable deadlines and be highly organised - Ability to work independently and confidence to act on own initiative	D E	I I

Salary and conditions of service

The salient features of conditions of service for Research and Analogous staff are as follows:

- Salary will be £38,205 per annum on Grade [5B] of the salary scales for Research and Analogous staff.
- Annual Leave is 30 days, plus 8 statutory and 4 additional days during the Christmas holiday period.
- Automatic entry into the Universities Superannuation Scheme (USS) with the option to opt out.
- ***This post is permanent with funding fixed term for 6 months.***
- ***This post is full time (1 FTE).***
- All offers of appointment are subject to City receiving satisfactory references and medical clearance.
- All posts at City are subject to reasonable adjustment under the Equalities Act (2010).
- All appointments at City are subject to a probationary period.
- The appointment is terminable by three months' notice on either side.

Applications

When preparing your application, you should address carefully the post details enclosed and in particular the qualities outlined in the Person Specification. Please include examples where appropriate.

All applications must be received by the advertised deadline.

Interviews will be held in the week commencing 12th February 2024

Further Information

City operates a no smoking policy.

City offers an excellent pension scheme, generous leave allowance, season ticket loan, a good working environment and access to fitness and social facilities.

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If you have a disability and are interested in this post, City welcomes your application. For an informal discussion you may wish to contact the Recruitment Team on:

Telephone: 020 7040 3085
E-mail: recruit@city.ac.uk